

Also known as: SVAR, AlgoApex, APEX, communication test, English test, speaking test

Audience: candidate

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Mock SVAR — spoken English assessment

1. What this is

Mock SVAR measures how well you use English — speaking, listening, reading, and vocabulary and grammar. You read sentences aloud, repeat sentences you hear, speak freely on a topic, answer listening questions, and answer vocabulary and grammar questions. It reports your level on the internationally recognised **CEFR** scale, from A1 (beginner) to C2 (mastery).

It **adapts**. Each section tracks your level separately and moves up or down based on how you perform, so the questions you get are pitched at your actual ability.

2. Who can use it

Every candidate, on both plans. It is **not** a PRO-only feature — Basic users get the full test and a report. PRO changes only how many attempts you get per week and gives you the advanced report.

3. Names and terms

A user might say	Meaning
communication test, English test, speaking test	Mock SVAR
AlgoApex, APEX	the engine behind Mock SVAR; the same thing
CEFR, A1–C2, level	your proficiency level
L1–L6	the same six levels: L1 = A1, L6 = C2
round, part	a section of the test

4. How it works, step by step

1. Open **Mock SVAR** and start a test. You need a working microphone.
2. Work through five kinds of question:

Section	What you do
Read aloud	A sentence appears; you read it out loud
Repeat sentence	You hear a sentence once and repeat it

Section	What you do
Free speech	You are given a topic and speak about it
Listening comprehension	You hear a conversation and answer multiple-choice questions
Vocabulary and grammar	Multiple-choice questions on words, idioms and grammar

1. Submit. Scoring happens in the background — speech has to be transcribed and analysed.
2. Your report appears under **Report**, with a level for each skill and a written summary.

Each test is **13 questions** in total, distributed across the five sections.

5. Rules, limits and timings

Rule	Basic	PRO
Attempts per week	3	4

- A microphone is required. Without it you cannot take the speaking sections.
- **You never see the same question twice.** Questions are drawn without repetition across all your attempts.
- Each section keeps its **own level**. You can be moving up in reading while holding steady in speaking — that is normal and intended.
- Once your weekly limit is reached you must wait for the week to roll over, or use an assessment credit from a top-up bundle.

6. How scoring works

The six levels:

Level	CEFR	Meaning
L1	A1	Beginner
L2	A2	Elementary
L3	B1	Intermediate
L4	B2	Upper intermediate
L5	C1	Advanced
L6	C2	Mastery

Your four skill scores are built up from the sections:

Skill	Built from
Speaking	Read aloud, repeat sentence, free speech
Listening	Repeat sentence, listening comprehension

Skill	Built from
Reading	Read aloud
Vocabulary and grammar	The vocabulary and grammar section

What is actually measured in your speech:

- **Pronunciation** — how clearly each word comes across.
- **Fluency** — your pace, how many filler words ("um", "uh") you use, and how long your pauses are. There is a target speaking speed for each level; being far above or below it costs marks.
- **Accuracy** — for read-aloud and repeat-sentence, how closely what you said matches what you were meant to say.
- **For free speech**, additionally: coherence, range of vocabulary, grammatical accuracy, and how well you manage a longer stretch of speech.

Multiple-choice questions are simply right or wrong.

How your level moves, per section:

Your performance at your current level	What happens
Below 30%	Drops a level immediately
30–49%	Drops a level if you score in this band twice in a row
50–84%	Stays where it is
85%+ but you struggled with the harder questions	Stays where it is
85%+ and you handled the harder questions well	Moves up a level after two such results in a row

Each test mixes questions at your level with a few from the level above (or below, if you are already at L6) — that is how it checks whether you are ready to move up.

7. What you get afterwards

- **A level for each of the four skills**, on the A1–C2 scale.
- **A progress score out of 100** per skill. Each level occupies about 17 points, so L3 sits between roughly 33 and 50. Moving from the bottom to the top of a level moves the score without changing the level — that is real progress, shown.
- **A written summary** of a few sentences explaining where you are and what to work on. If you have taken the test before, it includes how you have changed since last time.
- **Section-by-section scores.**

8. When things go wrong

"My score is much lower than I expected"

The most common causes are microphone quality and speaking speed. A distant or noisy microphone directly lowers pronunciation scores because the words come through less clearly. Speaking much faster or slower than natural pace costs fluency marks. Use a headset in a quiet room.

"I got dropped a level"

A single very weak section (below 30%) drops that section's level immediately, without waiting. It is not a punishment — the next test will pitch questions where you can actually show what you know, and you can move straight back up.

"My level did not go up even though I scored well"

Two things are required: a strong score at your level **and** handling the harder questions mixed into the test **and** doing both twice in a row. One excellent test is not enough by design.

"My speaking level is high but reading is low" (or any mismatch)

Each section is tracked separately and they genuinely can diverge. Reading is measured only from read-aloud, so it moves with your read-aloud performance specifically.

"The recording did not capture my answer"

Check the microphone permission in your browser and that no other app (Zoom, Meet, Teams) is holding the microphone. If a question recorded nothing, it scores as no answer.

"I have run out of attempts"

You get 3 per week on Basic and 4 on PRO. Wait for the week to roll over, upgrade, or buy an assessment bundle top-up.

"My report is not ready"

Speech has to be transcribed and analysed, so SVAR reports take longer than multiple-choice ones. Check the **Report** section; you get a notification when it is ready.

9. Common questions

Do I need to pay for SVAR? No. It is available on the free plan. PRO gives you one extra attempt per week and the advanced report.

How long does it take? Thirteen questions across five sections. Free-speech answers are the longest part.

Does my accent lower my score? No. It measures clarity, fluency, accuracy, vocabulary and grammar — not which accent you have.

Can I skip a question? Skipping scores that question as unanswered, which lowers the section score.

Can I retake it to get a better level? Yes, within your weekly limit. Levels move on consistent performance, not on one good attempt.

What is a good level? B2 (L4) is generally the threshold for confident professional communication in English. B1 (L3) is functional. The report tells you where you are and what is next.

Why did I get an easier test this time? Your level dropped in that section, so the questions are pitched lower. Score well and it moves back up.

Can I see the correct answers? The report gives you scores, levels and a written summary rather than an answer key.

10. What this does not do

- It does not test writing.
- It does not give you a pass or fail — it gives you a level.
- It does not judge your accent.
- It does not let you repeat a question or re-record an answer.
- It does not show the same question twice across attempts.

11. When to contact support

- An attempt was consumed but no report appeared after a reasonable wait.
- Recordings consistently capturing nothing despite microphone permission being granted.
- A level that changed in a way the rules above do not explain.